

for' (655); the above sense would require ἐπιτρέπον, i. e. 'deputing' (τὴν ἀρχήν), and the ellipse would be harsh.

(3) It is simplest therefore to make τὸ ἔθνος distributive, 'each nation took its place in order as ruler and administrator.' This sentence then simply repeats generally what H. has already said more definitely above; it may be a gloss, and Krüger brackets it.

135 Hellenicus (fr. 169; F. H. G. i. 68) says the Persians learned the practice of castration from the Babylonians; cf. H. iii. 92. 1.

ἰσθῆτα. H. describes the 'Median' armament (σκευή) of the Persian 'Immortals' in vii. 61 (v. n.); the real Persian dress was of leather (σκυτίνη), and its main feature the trousers (71. 2); such a dress, fitting closely, is worn by the common soldiers on the monuments, while the king and his attendants have a long flowing dress. (Rawlinson, *ad loc.*, gives pictures.) Cf. Strabo, 525, for the borrowing. Curzon, ii. 633, speaks of '(Persian) imitativeness long notorious in the East'. He also agrees with c. 134 as to Persian conceit (p. 628).

παισί: the vice was older and is denounced in the Vendidad (Farg. 8. 5; iv. 102); Greek influence may have helped to spread it.

136 I πολλοὺς παῖδας. Cf. Vend. Farg. 4. 47; iv. 46, 'He who has children is far above the childless man.' Large families were both commended for religious motives (Ormazd is the Lord of Life), and politically were all-important to a small ruling caste.

2 ἱππεύειν. Xenophon (Cyr. i. 3. 3) says that Cyrus made the Persians a nation of horsemen; this is thought by some (e.g. Meyer, iii. 9) to be a pure invention; it is argued that Xenophon, as a cavalry officer, wished his countrymen to develop that arm of their forces; hence Cyrus' supposed development is merely an object-lesson to the Greeks. But as the Persians were largely a race of mountaineers, cavalry can hardly have played much part among them till Cyrus began a career of conquest. Hence Xenophon may be right on this point.

ἀληθίζεσθαι. The importance of 'Truth' is brought out in the B. J. i. 10, 'The lie became abounding in the land'; iv. 13, (Ormazd helps Darius) 'because I was not wicked nor was I a liar' (cf. also col. iv. 4, 5, 6, 8). The liar is a 'Mithra-drug'; he offends against the all-seeing sun-god, who is the guardian of contracts (cf. 138. 1). For a transgression of the rule as to Truth cf. iii. 72 n. H. is right in crediting the Persians with the virtues of chivalry.

137 μηδένα is both subject and object; this double use of a word is frequent in H. (e.g. viii. 142. 3).

For compensation in mitigation of punishment cf. Sandoces, vii. 194. 2. The principle was extended to religion; in modern Parseeism every offence and every good deed has a price, and so a balance is struck (S. B. E. iv. 99 n.).

138 Aristotle (Hist. Anim. iii. 11, p. 518) describes the λεύκη, which seems to have been a mild form of leprosy. Leper isolation was